

SPACEX IS COMING: WHAT'S NEXT? A COMMUNITY BRIEF

Clear facts. Local context. A guide for the people who already call this place home.

YOU'RE INVITED

Friday, October 9, 2026

3:00 PM

Pecan Island Methodist Church

Next to the Fire Department



DIGITAL EVENT WEBSITE

Scan for the easy-to-read website, both articles, speaker information, and the digital handout.

THIS IS A COMMUNITY GUIDE — NOT AN OFFICIAL PROJECT DOCUMENT

We are not part of SpaceX or the State of Louisiana. Some details may change.



A BROWNSVILLE NATIVE WITH A FRONT-ROW VIEW

Craig Grove is coming to share what he lived through.

As SpaceX moved from a far-off idea to daily life around Brownsville, Boca Chica, and South Padre Island, Craig saw the changes from inside the community—not from a distance.



Craig Grove

BROKER / OWNER, GRT REALTY

Brownsville native • Rio Grande Valley real-estate professional • Creator of **The Brownsville Guy**

A perspective Pecan Island cannot get from a press release.

Craig grew up in Brownsville and has spent his career in the Rio Grande Valley. During the past decade, he watched SpaceX become part of the daily reality around Brownsville, Boca Chica, and South Padre Island.

He saw the talk before the change, then the new workers, business activity, traffic, land conversations, housing pressure, and the unexpected issues that followed. His experience does **not** mean Pecan Island will become Brownsville. It gives this community a real person to learn from before the same kind of change arrives here.

What he is not

Craig is not a SpaceX employee, project spokesperson, or public official. He is here to share his community's lived experience—the good, the difficult, and the surprises.

WHY CRAIG IS HERE

Brownsville did not have anyone to call. Pecan Island does.

Craig's keynote gives local families, camp owners, landowners, and businesses a real community experience to learn from before decisions and change accelerate here.

Craig Grove public contact: Cell 956-832-4458 • Work 956-254-0869 • GRT Realty, Brownsville, TX

ALSO SPEAKING

Mike Kloesel **MAYOR OF KAPLAN**

Mike brings local public-leader context and will share what he knows about nearby activity, including the reported 16 Tesla Superchargers near Larry's Super Foods.



SCAN • FOLLOW •

LIKE

The Brownsville Guy

For current Brownsville, Boca Chica, and Rio Grande Valley updates.

WHAT IS ANNOUNCED — AND WHAT IS STILL OPEN

What we know. What is not set.

The project is real. Many on-the-ground details are still in development.

ANNOUNCED

SpaceX plans a Louisiana site.

SpaceX and the state announced Starbase Louisiana near Pecan Island. Construction is targeted to begin by the end of 2027, with a first launch as soon as 2029.

IN DEVELOPMENT

Roads, a bridge, and a wharf are in review.

A coastal-use application describes access roads, a bridge, wharves, work areas, and dredging. These are not final permits or final plans.

NOT SET

Many local details remain open.

There is no final public road route, private-parcel buy list, launch schedule, utility plan, noise map, or answer for how any one property may be affected.

A large tract does not mean every acre is a building site.

The former Exxon property sold to SpaceX is about **125,000 acres**. SpaceX says it will not develop the full footprint and plans to preserve wetlands and wildlife habitat. Public reporting also describes a smaller, roughly 40,000-acre coastal development area.

How this guide stays current

We are monitoring public updates from SpaceX, Louisiana Economic Development, DOTD, DNR/OCM, and other permitting agencies. When public documents change the picture, this website and handout can be updated.



Digital community guide

Scan for the current website, handout, speaker information, and future updates.

WHAT IS IN A PERMIT APPLICATION

Some plans are on paper. They are not final yet.

A coastal-use application describes a heavy-haul road, a long bridge, wharves, work areas, and dredging. This tells us what may be studied. It does not mean the work is approved or ready to start.



Organizer-provided map image. It is not an official final engineering map.

The main point

Road, bridge, water, and dredging work may shape daily access. The final design, route, cost, and timing are not public yet.

Highway 82

DOTD says it is evaluating transportation routes, road and bridge conditions, traffic impacts, and possible Highway 82 improvements with the project team.

What has not been announced

There is no confirmed four-lane highway from I-10 to Pecan Island. We did not find an official plan that confirms the Rayne or Duson routes discussed locally.

What we are monitoring

DOTD updates, permit status, construction schedules, traffic planning, and emergency-access information will matter as public documents are released.

Keep the distinction clear

A route under discussion is not the same as a route that has been chosen. We will update this guide when an official route or construction plan is published.

SAME KIND OF CHANGE. DIFFERENT STARTING POINT.

Pecan Island is not a repeat of Brownsville.

Craig's experience gives us context. It does not create a blueprint. The land, nearby services, physical setting, and project stage are different.

LAND SCALE — THREE DIFFERENT MEASURES

Louisiana starts with far more land access.

125,000 acres: the Louisiana former-Exxon tract SpaceX is expected to access. SpaceX says it plans to use only a small portion while preserving wetlands.

About 350 acres: the reported Texas Starbase industrial/launch site. **About 8,100 acres:** the City of Starbase boundary after its 2026 annexation. A city boundary is not the same as the SpaceX facility or company ownership.

THE SCALE CONTRAST

125,000 acres compared with a 350-acre Texas industrial site is roughly **357 times** more land context—not a forecast that Louisiana's built facility will be 357 times larger.

COMMUNITY, DISTANCE & SERVICE BASE

Texas has closer, denser nearby support.

Starbase is about **24 miles / 42 minutes** from Brownsville and **41 miles / 64 minutes** from South Padre Island. Pecan Island is about **33 miles / 50 minutes** from Kaplan, **38 miles / 58 minutes** from Abbeville, and **59 miles / 89 minutes** from Lafayette.

Kaplan and Abbeville are important nearby communities. They are closer than Lafayette—but the larger regional base of hotels, rooms, restaurants, groceries, labor, and visitor services is still much thinner than the Brownsville–South Padre area.

30-MILE MAP SNAPSHOT — NOT A BUSINESS CENSUS

OpenStreetMap listed 268 food-service and 179 grocery/convenience locations near Starbase, versus 10 and 5 near Pecan Island. This does not count hotel rooms, rental units, or every business.

WHAT'S THE SAME / WHAT'S DIFFERENT

What is the same

Both are Gulf Coast Starship sites. Both need heavy construction, workers, traffic management, power, water, coastal protection, and launch access over open water.

What is different

Louisiana starts with more documented acreage, more marsh, a smaller nearby service base, and a company that already has years of Texas Starship lessons.

Launch rate: now vs. goal

Texas launched 3 Starships from May 22–Sept. 28, 2026—about 1 every 6 weeks. Louisiana is planned for 10 pads and official capacity of thousands annually. Musk has separately stated a long-range aspiration of 30+ flights a day; that is not a permit or schedule.

The practical takeaway

Brownsville shows the kinds of community change a major spaceport can bring. Pecan Island's larger tract, more marsh, smaller local service base, and newer project plan mean the details may unfold very differently here.

Sources: SpaceX Flight 12–14; FAA; Louisiana Economic Development; Ars Technica; Rio Grande Valley Business Journal; OSRM routes; OpenStreetMap snapshot; NOLA.com; City of Brownsville; Louisiana Folklife; NPR; and U.S. Fish & Wildlife. Texas acreage measures are not interchangeable.

A large project can change daily life before it is finished.

Traffic, food, housing, services, and local roads can feel pressure when workers arrive at the same time. The key unknown is when that demand may arrive.

OFFICIALLY ANNOUNCED

3,000 direct jobs over 10 years

SpaceX and Louisiana say the project will create more than 3,000 direct jobs. SpaceX says it plans to hire heavily from nearby communities. Louisiana also says the full site is expected to include employee housing.



Texas Starbase Airstreams — user-supplied photo

COMMUNITY SCENARIO — NOT CONFIRMED

30,000-35,000 workers at peak construction

Leaders and local sources have discussed this possible peak. We could not find an official project document that confirms this number, the peak year, or how long the peak would last.



Texas Starbase housing — user-supplied photo

What this could mean for Pecan Island

If a large outside workforce arrives before places to stay can catch up, demand for rentals, RV sites, food, fuel, and services could rise. That is a planning possibility—not a promise that rents will rise by a certain amount or at a certain time.

TIMING

Official sources say construction is expected in 2027 and a first launch is targeted as soon as 2029. There is no official public peak-workforce schedule.

WHAT WE ARE MONITORING

Public information about worker transportation, employee housing, traffic management, local services, and construction timing will help show when the largest pressure could arrive.

FACTS FIRST. NO PRESSURE.

Private land: what we know today.

There is no public private-parcel buy list. Land may matter to the project in different ways, but no owner should assume a specific need or offer.



Green outlines show the organizer-provided former Exxon property map. It is a reference only, not an official SpaceX parcel or acquisition map.

CONFIRMED LAND TRANSACTION

The former Exxon property is already part of the project story.

Public reporting says Exxon donated a broader **125,000-acre** property to Louisiana as part of a coastal-lawsuit settlement. The state then sold it to SpaceX for **\$100 million**.

NOT PUBLICLY IDENTIFIED

No private-parcel need has been announced.

We did not find a public SpaceX map, offer list, or agency document naming privately owned parcels it wants to buy, lease, or use.

LOCAL WORD-OF-MOUTH — NOT A SPACEX PLAN

What people are saying about Highway 82 and Front Ridge Road

We have heard that privately owned land south of Highway 82, near Front Ridge Road, could be more important for project needs. We have also heard that land on or north of Highway 82 might still be of interest, but may be less critical.

We could not verify either claim with SpaceX, DOTD, or a permitting agency.

Only if you want Keaty to know about your land

This is not a listing and your property will not be publicly marketed. There is no commitment and no obligation. If you may consider renting, selling, leasing, or supporting a future use **only if a real need arises**, you can share your property privately. If Keaty later speaks with a potential buyer, tenant, investor, or user whose need may fit, the team can identify your property and contact you. You stay in control.



Private property information

Optional. No listing. No public marketing.

No obligation.



Levi A. Kastner

KASTNER INSURANCE GROUP

Insurance Advisor, CWCA

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REFERENCE LINKS



Community website



Kaplan proposed
RV park ordinance



Vermilion Parish
proposed ordinance

The two ordinance documents are organizer-provided references and are proposed documents, not adopted law.

A final reminder

This guide is independent. It is not made by SpaceX, the State of Louisiana, DOTD, or a permitting agency. Information can change. We are monitoring public updates and will revise this guide when meaningful new details are released.

STAY INFORMED. STAY CONNECTED. THE COMMUNITY COMES FIRST.